National Ethics Application Form

Version 2008 - V2.0

Proposal title: **High performance athletes at school: A study of conflicting demands**

For submission to:
University of the Sunshine Coast Human Research Ethics Committee (EC00297)

Name: **Ms Maureen O'Neill**

Address: **12 Allamanda Avenue**
Little Mountain, Caloundra QLD 4551

Contact: (Bus) **0458041960**
(AH) **0754928670**
(Mob) **0458041960**
(Fax) **54565004**

Proposal status: **Complete**

Proposal description:

This research project explores the competing demands on young people who are both high performance athletes yet still at school. How they cope, and what models of schooling may best support them are the main research questions. Three phenomena have resulted in a growing number of school students who are also high performance athletes. One is the increasing range and number of international sports competitions; second is the younger age of many competitors; and the third is the requirement for young people to stay at school until they are 17 years old. These young people have to meet the demands and commitments of being both a full time high school student and a full time high performance athlete. In essence, these young high performance athletes at school are trying to fit two lives into one.
This project is a qualitative study, within an interpretivist paradigm. Using in-depth interviews to gather data, the research aims to develop theory around the conflicting needs of the high school-age, high performance athlete. The research question thus focuses on two aspects: first, how these young people cope with their dual lives; and second, what are the models of schooling that may best support them in their endeavours.
The study is seeking data from four groups of participants:
i) Men and women over the age of 18 years who were a high performance athletes while at school;
ii) Young people in the age category of 15 -18 years who are high performance athletes and are still currently of school-age;
iii) Parents of current or past high performance school-age athletes;
iv) School teachers and officials who have had experience of, and worked with, school-age high performance athletes.
One of the main, expected outcomes is to collect and analyse data that will provide evidence to develop a model of schooling that may help these talented athletes who are still at school to cope better in their demanding lives.

Previously submitted to:

Administrative Section

1. TITLE AND SUMMARY OF PROJECT

1.1. Title

1.1.1 What is the formal title of this research proposal?

High performance athletes at school: A study of conflicting demands

1.2. Description of the project in plain language

1.2.1 Give a concise and simple description (not more than 400 words), in plain language, of the aims of this project, the proposal research design and the methods to be used to achieve those aims.

This research project explores the competing demands on young people who are both high performance athletes yet still at school. How they cope, and what models of schooling may best support them are the main research questions. Three phenomena have resulted in a growing number of school students who are also high performance athletes. One is the increasing range and number of international sports competitions; second is the younger age of many competitors; and the third is the requirement for young people to stay at school until they are 17 years old. These young people have to meet the demands and commitments of being both a full time high school student and a full time high performance athlete. In essence, these young high performance athletes at school are trying to fit two lives into one.

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The study is seeking data from four groups of participants:

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One of the main, expected outcomes is to collect and analyse data that will provide evidence to develop a model of schooling that may help these talented athletes who are still at school to cope better in their demanding lives.

2. RESEARCHERS / INVESTIGATORS

2.2. Principal researcher(s) / investigator(s)

2.2.0 How many principal researchers / investigators are there? 1

2.2.1. Principal researcher / investigator 1

2.2.1. Name and contact details

Name:	Ms Maureen O'Neill	
Address:	12 Allamanda Avenue Little Mountain, Caloundra QLD 4551	
Organisation:	University of the Sunshine Coast	
Area:	Faculty of Science, Health and Education	
Position:	PhD fulltime student	
Contact	(Bus) 0458041960 (Mob) 0458041960	(AH) 0754928670 (Fax) 54565004
Email:	moneill@usc.edu.au	

2.2.2... Summary of qualifications and relevant expertise NS 4.8.7 NS 4.8.15

Maureen O'Neill has been both a primary and secondary teacher for 18 years in schools throughout Australia in the States of New South Wales and Queensland. Recently she has progressed to confirmed candidature in the Doctor of Philosophy program within the Faculty of Science, Health and Education at the University of the Sunshine Coast. She is currently involved in tutoring in teacher education and business at the University of the Sunshine Coast for both undergraduate and postgraduate programs. Further, she tutors in the Tertiary Preparation Pathways courses and is a qualified and current Indigenous Torres Strait and Thursday Islander (ITAS) tutor at the University of the Sunshine Coast, Barunga Centre. During her years of teaching Maureen has supervised many practice teachers training in preschool to Year 12 levels of teaching in a variety of schooling models.Further, she has had experience in working with young people,their parents and teachers.She has supervised and coordinated a number of federally funded education programs within Sunshine Coast schools including the "An Even Start" program for numeracy and literacy for both indigenous and non-indigenous students from years 4 to 9. Maureen is a qualified coach in Surf Lifesaving, Athletics and Royal Lifesaving and has worked with high performance athletes of school age, as well as being a mother of 6 children who have been national or international athletes while still at school. Additionally, she has experience in supervising the Senior Studies exams for Year 12 students in New South Wales and Queensland. Maureen has listings on the Coast Research Database in reference to her PhD study of high performance school-age athletes. Maureen also holds a current 'Blue card' from the Commission for Children and Young People and Child Guardian.

2.2.2... Please declare any general competing interests

There are no competing interests.

2.2.2... Name the site(s) for which this principal researcher / investigator is responsible.

The University of the Sunshine Coast.

2.2.3 Describe the role of the principal researcher / investigator in this project.

As the principal researcher / investigator I will be doing the: literature review, recruiting, interviews, transcription of the interviews, analysis of data and write-up of research.

2.2.4 Is the principal researcher / investigator a student? Yes

2.2.4...What is the educational organisation, faculty and degree course of the student?

Organisation	University of the Sunshine Coast
Faculty	Faculty of Science, Health and Education
Degree course	PhD

2.2.4... Is this research project part of the assessment of the student? Yes

2.2.4... Is the student's involvement in this project elective or compulsory? Compulsory

2.2.4... What training or experience does the student have in the relevant research methodology?

I have already undertaken research studies in PhD and have been prepared by my supervisors in data collection and management. Further to this, I have completed compulsory candidature course EDU 750

Research Paradigms. I have also completed an introductory course on data analysis with the tool N-Vivo.I have given a paper on the project to the Post-graduate Students Conference at the University of Queensland, where I gained additional advice on the conduct of my research project.

2.2.4... What training has the student received in the ethics of research?
I have had training in Ethics workshops conducted by the Ethics in Research Officer at USC, and from my supervisors at the University of the Sunshine Coast.

2.2.4... Describe the supervision to be provided to the student. NS 4.8.8
My principal supervisor is Dr. Bill Allen who is currently supervising some 10 PhD students and has supervised 4 masters by research students to successful completion. My other supervisor, Ms Angela Calder is a highly experienced coach of high performance athletes and has conducted research and written papers on high performance sports in Australia.

2.2.4... How many supervisors does the student have? 2

2.2.4...Supervisor 1

2.2.4...Provide the name, qualifications, and expertise, relevant to this research, of the students' supervisor

Title	Dr
First Name	Bill
Surname	Allen
Summary of qualifications and relevant expertise	Dr Bill Allen was a high school teacher for 28 years, in schools in England and in Western Australia. He is involved in teacher education in the Graduate Diploma and Undergraduate programs, and in the professional development of practitioners in post-graduate programs at Graduate Certificate and Master's levels. He supervises Doctoral students in a range of areas, with a particular interest in teacher education in developing countries. He has published in areas of school history, school operations, assessment, and high school/university transition. He has become deeply involved in school education in Indonesia and has led courses in the development of teachers and school leaders there.Publications; Many of Dr Bill Allen's publications are available from the Coast Research Database.

2.2.4...Supervisor 2

2.2.4...Provide the name, qualifications, and expertise, relevant to this research, of the students' supervisor

Title	Ms
First Name	Angela
Surname	Calder
Summary of qualifications and relevant expertise	Name: Ms Angela Calder Address: University of the Sunshine Coast School of Health and Sport Sciences Maroochydore DC QLD 4558 Australia Organisation: University of the Sunshine Coast Area: School of Health and Sport Sciences Position: Lecturer in Coaching Science Contact (Bus) 07 5459 5152 (AH) - (Fax) 07 5459 4600 Email: acalder@usc.edu.au Summary of qualifications and relevant expertise BA. Otago. MA(First Class). Otago. B.App.Sci.(Sports Coaching). Canberra Angela has been actively involved in coaching science since 1987. From 1990 to 2002 she worked for the Australian Sports Commission (ASC) in both the Australian Institute of Sport and Participation Divisions as a science editor, coach educator, and high performance consultant. Angela has over 90 publications mostly designed to inform coaches, athletes and officials, about

sports science applications to their training and coaching practices. Angela is an editorial board member of an international sport science journal and an external consultant and reviewer for the national coach and officiating accreditation programs of the ASC.

2.3. Associate researcher(s) / investigator(s)

2.3.1 How many known associate researchers are there? (You will be asked to give contact details for these associate researchers / investigators at question 2.3.1.1)	0
2.3.2 Do you intend to employ other associate researchers / investigators?	No

2.4. Contact

Provide the following information for the person making this application to the HREC.

2.4.1. Name and contact details

Name:	Ms Maureen O'Neill	
Address:	12 Allamanda Avenue Little Mountain, Caloundra QLD 4551	
Organisation:	University of the Sunshine Coast	
Area:	Faculty of Science, Health and Education	
Position:	PhD fulltime student	
Contact	(Bus) 0458041960 (Mob) 0458041960	(AH) 0754928670 (Fax) 54565004
Email:	moneill@usc.edu.au	

2.5. Other personnel relevant to the research project

2.5.1 How many known other people will play a specified role in the conduct of this research project?	0
2.5.2 Is it intended that other people, not yet known, will play a specified role in the conduct of this research project?	No

2.6. Certification of researchers / investigators

2.6.1 Are there any relevant certification, accreditation or credentialing requirements relevant to the conduct of this research?	No

2.7. Training of researchers / investigators

2.7.1 Do the researchers / investigators or others involved in any aspect of this research project require any additional training in order to undertake this research?	No

3. RESOURCES

3.1. Project Funding / Support

3.1.1. Indicate how the project will be funded

3.1.1... Type of funding.
[Please note that all fields in any selected funding detail column (with the exception of the code) will need to be completed.]

	By Researchers Department or Organisation
Name of Grant / Sponsor	School of Science and Education
Amount of funding	None
Code (optional)	NA
Confirmed / Sought	Not Sought
Detail in kind support	NA
Indicate the extent to which the scope of this HREC application and grant are aligned	NA

3.1.1... How will you manage a funding shortfall (if any)?
Not applicable

3.1.2 Will the project be supported in other ways eg. in-kind support/equipment by an external party eg. sponsor No

3.2. Duality of Interest

3.2.1 Describe any commercialisation or intellectual property implications of the funding/support arrangement.
There are none.

3.2.2 Does the funding/support provider(s) have a financial interest in the outcome of the research? No

3.2.3 Does any member of the research team have any affiliation with the provider(s) of funding/support, or a financial interest in the outcome of the research? No

3.2.4 Does any other individual or organisation have an interest in the outcome of this research No

3.2.5 Are there any restrictions on the publication of results from this research? No

4. PRIOR REVIEWS

4.1. Ethical review

4.1.0. Duration and location

4.1.0... In how many Australian sites, or site types, will the research be conducted? 1

4.1.0... In how many overseas sites, or site types, will the research be conducted? 0

Provide the following information for each site or site type (Australian and overseas, if applicable) at which the research is to be conducted

4.1.0...Site / Site Type 1

4.1.0... Site / Site Type Name
University of the Sunshine Coast

4.1.0... Site / Site Type Location
University of the Sunshine Coast
Sippy Downs Drive,
SIPPY DOWNS
Queensland. 4556

4.1.0...Provide the start and finish dates for the whole of the study including data analysis

Anticipated start date 31/07/2011

Anticipated finish date 15/11/2012

4.1.0... Are there any time-critical aspects of the research project of which an HREC should be aware? No

4.1.1 To how many Australian HRECs (representing site organisations or the researcher's / investigator's organisation) is it intended that this research proposal be submitted? 1

4.1.1...HREC 1

4.1.1... Name of HREC University of the Sunshine Coast Human Research Ethics Committee (EC00297)

4.1.1...Provide the start and finish dates for the research for which this HREC is providing ethical review.

Anticipated start date or date range 31/07/2011

Anticipated finish date or date range 15/11/2012

4.1.1... For how many sites at which the research is to be conducted will this HREC provide ethical review? 1

4.1.1...Site 1

4.1.1... Name of site University of the Sunshine Coast

4.1.1... Which of the researchers / investigators involved in this project will conduct the research at this site?

Principal Researcher(s)	Associate Researcher(s)
Ms Maureen O'Neill	

4.1.2 Have you previously submitted an application, whether in NEAF of otherwise, for ethical review of this research project to any other HRECs? No

4.3. Peer review

4.3.1 Has the research proposal, including design, methodology and evaluation undergone, or will it undergo, a peer review process? NS 1.2 Yes

4.3.1... Provide details of the review and the outcome. A copy of the letter / notification, where available, should be attached to this application.
This application has been peer-reviewed by MS Kylie Readman, Lecturer in Education, Doctoral candidate and leader of several research projects funded by the University.

Ethical Review Section

Summary

Applicant / Principal Researcher(s)

Ms Maureen O'Neill

Maureen O'Neill has been both a primary and secondary teacher for 18 years in schools throughout Australia in the States of New South Wales and Queensland. Recently she has progressed to confirmed candidature in the Doctor of Philosophy program within the Faculty of Science, Health and Education at the University of the Sunshine Coast. She is currently involved in tutoring in teacher education and business at the University of the Sunshine Coast for both undergraduate and postgraduate programs. Further, she tutors in the Tertiary Preparation Pathways courses and is a qualified and current Indigenous Torres Strait and Thursday Islander (ITAS) tutor at the University of the Sunshine Coast, Barunga Centre. During her years of teaching Maureen has supervised many practice teachers training in preschool to Year 12 levels of teaching in a variety of schooling models.Further, she has had experience in working with young people,their parents and teachers.She has supervised and coordinated a number of federally funded education programs within Sunshine Coast schools including the "An Even Start" program for numeracy and literacy for both indigenous and non-indigenous students from years 4 to 9. Maureen is a qualified coach in Surf Lifesaving, Athletics and Royal Lifesaving and has worked with high performance athletes of school age, as well as being a mother of 6 children who have been national or international athletes while still at school. Additionally, she has experience in supervising the Senior Studies exams for Year 12 students in New South Wales and Queensland. Maureen has listings on the Coast Research Database in reference to her PhD study of high performance school-age athletes. Maureen also holds a current 'Blue card' from the Commission for Children and Young People and Child Guardian.

Potential conflicts of interest

There are no competing interests.

Other Relevant Personnel

Dr Bill Allen

Dr Bill Allen was a high school teacher for 28 years, in schools in England and in Western Australia. He is involved in teacher education in the Graduate Diploma and Undergraduate programs, and in the professional development of practitioners in post-graduate programs at Graduate Certificate and Master's levels. He supervises Doctoral students in a range of areas, with a particular interest in teacher education in developing countries. He has published in areas of school history, school operations, assessment, and high school/university transition. He has become deeply involved in school education in Indonesia and has led courses in the development of teachers and school leaders there.Publications;

Many of Dr Bill Allen's publications are available from the Coast Research Database.

Ms Angela Calder

Name: Ms Angela Calder
Address: University of the Sunshine Coast
School of Health and Sport Sciences
Maroochydore DC QLD 4558
Australia
Organisation: University of the Sunshine Coast
Area: School of Health and Sport Sciences
Position: Lecturer in Coaching Science
Contact (Bus) 07 5459 5152 (AH) -
(Fax) 07 5459 4600
Email: acalder@usc.edu.au
Summary of qualifications and relevant expertise BA. Otago. MA(First Class). Otago. B.App.Sci.(Sports Coaching). Canberra

Angela has been actively involved in coaching science since 1987. From 1990 to 2002 she worked for the Australian Sports Commission (ASC) in both the Australian Institute of Sport and Participation Divisions as a science editor, coach educator, and high performance consultant. Angela has over 90 publications mostly designed to inform coaches, athletes and officials, about sports science applications to their training and coaching practices. Angela is an editorial board member of an international sport science journal and an external consultant and reviewer for the national coach and officiating accreditation programs of the ASC.

5. PROJECT

5.1. Type of Research

5.1.1 Tick as many of the following 'types of research' as apply to this project. Your answers will assist HRECs in considering your proposal. A tick in some of these boxes will generate additional questions relevant to your proposal (mainly because the National Statement requires additional ethical matters to be considered), which will appear in Section 9 of NEAF.

This project involves:

[X] Research using qualitative methods NS 3.1

5.1.2 Does the research involve limited disclosure to participants? NS 2.3 No

5.1.3 Are the applicants asking the HREC / review body to waive the requirement of consent? NS 2.3.5 No

5.2. Research plan

5.2.1 Describe the theoretical, empirical and/or conceptual basis, and background evidence, for the research proposal, eg. previous studies, anecdotal evidence, review of literature, prior observation, laboratory or animal studies (4000 character limit). NS 1.1

Currently in Australia there are increasing numbers of athletes (Australian Bureau of Statistics, 2009) who are competing at a very high level of sport but are still of school-age. Such athletes are likely to be recognisable in international competition sports like swimming and gymnastics, but they are also evident in increasing numbers in other sports across Australia. For such young international competitors who must still be at school the question arises as to how they cope with the demands of being both a high level sport competitor and with meeting the social and educational demands of being a full time student at school. This is the basis of this study.

The literature is organised around five main themes. The first theme revolves around a definition of these school-age athletes, identifying some of the features about the broad cohort and justifying the need to find out more about these athletes (Calder, 2006, 2011;Olds, Dollman, & Maher, 2009). The second theme lies in the literature that informs this study of the range and types of difficulties or problems that these young people may face (Burden, Tremayne, & Marsh, 2004; Cheng, Marsh, Dowson, & Martin, 2006; Christensen & Sørensen, 2009; Radtke & Coalter, 2007). An interesting feature is that the research in these sources tend to be focussed on one problem of the athlete, and is rarely confined to the school-aged athlete per se. The third theme in the literature is an exploration of the models of schooling that are available to the school-age high performance athlete in Australia (Commonwealth of Australia, 2010; Department of Education, Employment & Workplace Relations [DEEWR], 2011). The literature here is far more descriptive and contextual. The fourth theme around which the literature is organised is that concerned with aspects of schooling that might be important to the young people looking at pursuing both sport and academic endeavours whilst still at school (Best, 1999; Lang, 1984; Lang, Best & Litchenberg, 1994; Wenden, 2003). Finally, exploring the literature that links schooling and high performance athletes in jurisdictions outside Australia provides the fifth theme (Canadian Sports Centre, 2010;Parris, 2007).

A tenet underpinning the design of this study was that these young people face a number of problems when combining the endeavours of being a full-time school student and athlete. Potential conflicting demands of being both a full-time athlete and a school student are expected to arise. What became clear from the review is that the literature focuses on a singular problem approach, rather than from an integration of all the problems that a school-age high performance athlete may face.

Time may be the over-riding problem for these athletes because so many of their demands impact on the limited number of hours in a day. However, as Burden et al. (2004), Finney (2001), Gurkan(2009), Helsen, Starkes and Van Winckel (1998), McKenzie et al. (2003), Palmer (2010), Radtke and Coalter (2007) and Walshaw (2010) suggest there are other problems facing these athletes. Meeting and handling the demands of the training and of school curriculum is a function of time management. Nevertheless, the school-age high performance athlete is attempting to address the demands of school and sport commitments and each of these may be full-time demands on a young person's life (Burden et al., 2004). Anderson and Butzin (1974) and Burden et al. (2004) suggest fatigue resulting from training and competition demands may temper athlete motivation to engage in a high level of academic undertaking.

The literature reviewed for this study has helped construct a framework of references by which the in-depth interviews of athletes, officials and parents may be conducted. It seeks to explore the models of 'athlete friendly' and 'athlete unfriendly' and the implications of these models particularly on policy.

See full reference list in Appendix A.

5.2.2 State the aims of the research and the research question and/or hypotheses, where appropriate.

Research Question and Guiding Questions:

The research question underpinning the study is:

What are the needs and problems of high performance athletes who are still at school, and what are the

characteristics of successful schooling models that best meets the needs of these young people?
The research guiding questions that direct the study and analysis are:
1. What are the goals and expected outcomes that school-age high performance athletes have, and how might these different goals be in conflict?
2. What schooling models exist in Australia for school-age high performance athletes?
3. What are the experiences of the high performance athlete at school within different schooling models?
4. How do high performance athletes (who have left school) identify the strengths and weaknesses of the school model they were in?
The research guiding questions will be helpful in guiding the data collection and analysis as the study moves towards a better understanding of how different models of schooling in Australia may support high performance athletes at school as they pursue their sporting ambitions in line with other educational aims.
Aims
This study has two major, related aims. The first is to find out what needs and problems the school-age high performance athletes themselves identify when they combine high level sport and academic endeavours. The second is to examine some models of schooling in Australia that may best support the high performance athlete who is still at school. Further, the aim is to propose features or models of school-age high performance athletes in pursuing their sporting ambitions concomitantly with other educational aims. To do this, this study will set out to determine what the needs of school-age high performance athletes might be and to identify the relationships and potential conflicts arising from these needs. The research seeks to do this by collecting data in the first place from athletes themselves, thereby giving them voice to outline their problems, parents and school officials.

5.2.3 Has this project been undertaken previously? No

5.3. Benefits/Risks

5.3.0 Does the research involve a practice or intervention which is an alternative to a standard practice or intervention? No

5.3.2 What expected benefits (if any) will this research have for the wider community?

The expected benefits of the research to the wider community lies in the intended outcome of this study which is to develop two theoretical models of schooling with regard to the needs of the school-age high performance athlete. The first theoretical model is one that proposes the characteristics of what might be termed an 'athlete-friendly' school. In this theoretical model it is not expected to describe an ideal institution but rather to develop a holistic model that may be applicable in a range of schools. Such a model or template perhaps, will attempt to include the positive components of a school or learning environment supportive of school-age high performance athletes. The other model is intended to outline what might be termed the 'athlete-unfriendly' components of schooling. The intention in this model is to outline the features and the school interactions that obstruct the school-age high performance athlete from achieving his/her aim in both areas of life.
This research may contribute to knowledge because it takes its focus as the school-age athlete, and seeks to determine the problems and difficulties that these students face from this premise. By analysing the benefits of two theoretical models in regards to the needs of the school-age athlete it may improve the likelihood of such students receiving a more equitable and inclusive education within schools throughout Australia.

5.3.3 What expected benefits (if any) will this research have for participants? NS 2.1

For some of the participants the expected benefits may be in the capacity this study provides them a voice to their experiences of being a high performance athlete whilst they were at school. Most of the participants may have left school and this study may give them the opportunity to contribute some knowledge to the problems and needs young people face in attempting to combine sport and education simultaneously. Further, this research may help achieve the utilitarian demands of schooling which, for the young athlete, is the successful attainment of a high enough standard to go on to university or to gain a job (Council, 1992). Consequently, as Duda (1989, 2007) and Nicholls (1989) have theorised, there may need to be a balance in the relationship between the demands of sport, the values and development of social responsibility in high performance athletes at school, and achieving the educational qualifications necessary for entry into university or employment at the end of one's sporting career.

5.3.4 Are there any risks to participants as a result of participation in this research project? NS 2.1 Yes

5.3.5 Explain how the likely benefit of the research justifies the risks of harm or discomfort to participants. NS 1.6

Since the researcher is specifically asking many of the participants about the problems that they had this may create some discomforts. Furthermore, time pressures may arise in regard to the participants who are school students with their workloads. The workload from studies and sport can induce considerable stress for many people, not only when studying but in the workforce. Therefore, many of the participants in this study are likely to had or still have significant stress and when asked to talk about this will experience some

discomfort. The way in which this will be managed is by adjusting interviews to allow participants to vent feelings, act supportively and further refer them to a counselling service such as Lifeline.
Other possible sources of discomfort involves interviews the researcher will have with both parents and children. In most cases parents may mitigate discomfort in the interview, but there may be some cases this may not be the situation. Some conflict could arise from the parent and child having differing answers to questions the researcher asks in relation to study and sport. In this case the researcher will gently remind and suggest to the parent the interview is to the encourage and gather perspectives form the child's point of view.
If a child is not happy about the parent being present for the interview, then the interview will not proceed with both of them. Hence, the children will be first asked if they would like a parent present or alternatively are happy to have their parent present. The parent will be made aware that the interview is for the child and suggest nicely that the answers need to be from the child allowing them to express their views without interruption from the parent, including the parent resisting the urge to talk over the child. If the parent is involved in the parent's participation group all will be interviewed separately.
The likely benefits for the participants will be in their contribution to important knowledge of the needs and problems of young athletes who are still at school who attempt to combine sport and education at the same time.

5.3.8 Are there any other risks involved in this research? eg. to the research team, the organisation, others	No
5.3.9 Is it anticipated that the research will lead to commercial benefit for the investigator(s) and or the research sponsor(s)?	No
5.3.11 Is there a risk that the dissemination of results could cause harm of any kind to individual participants - whether their physical, psychological, spiritual, emotional, social or financial well-being, or to their employability or professional relationships - or to their communities?	No

5.4. Monitoring

Refer to NS 3.3.19 - 3.3.25

5.4.1 What mechanisms do the researchers / investigators intend to implement to monitor the conduct and progress of the research project? NS 5.5

All the data collection processes and data analysis will be continuously reviewed by my supervisors Dr Bill Allen and Ms Angela Calder from the University of the Sunshine Coast. They have already provided me with initial training and preparation in the interview process, the data analysis and its conduct.

6. PARTICIPANTS

6.1. Research participants

6.1.1 The National Statement identifies the need to pay additional attention to ethical issues associated with research involving certain specific populations.

This question aims to assist you and the HREC to identify and address ethical issues that are likely to arise in your research, if its design will include one or more of these populations. Further, the National Statement recognizes the cultural diversity of Australia's population and the importance of respect for that diversity in the recruitment and involvement of participants. Your answer to this question will guide you to additional questions (if any) relevant to the participants in your study.

6.1.1 Tick as many of the following 'types of research participants' who will be included because of the project design, or their inclusion is probable, given the diversity of Australia's population. If none apply, please indicate this below.

	a) Primary intent of research	b) Probable coincidental recruitment
Children and/or young people (ie. <18 years) NS 4.2	[X]	[ ]
Aboriginal and/or Torres Strait Islander peoples NS 4.7	[ ]	[X]

You have indicated that it is probable that

- Aboriginal and/or Torres Strait Islander peoples

may be coincidentally recruited into this project. The National Statement identifies specific ethical considerations for these groups(s).

6.1.3... Please explain how you will address these considerations in your proposed research.
Young people under 18. Interviews from a select group of children who are mature enough to answer questions about their athletic demands and their schooling demands. Consent for these interviews will be sought from their parents who will be invited to, and may, accompany them at the interview. Parents will be invited to stay to ensure that their child is not placed at any risk.
Indigenous (Aboriginal and/or Torres Straits peoples): The Indigineity of athletes, teachers or parents is not known and it is not a specific aspect of the research. If a person identifies themselves as Indigenous, this will be met as they want, and the researcher is very aware of protocols surrounding Indigenous peoples.

6.2. Participant description

6.2.1 How many participant groups are involved in this research project? 4

6.2.2 What is the expected total number of participants in this project at all sites?
50

6.2.3. Group 1

6.2.3... Group name for participants in this group
Athletes who have left school and over 18 years

6.2.3... Expected number of participants in this group
14

6.2.3... Age range
Over 18 years old

6.2.3... Other relevant characteristics of this participant group
The participants will have been a high performance athlete while they were still at school.

6.2.3... Why are these characteristics relevant to the aims of the project?
It is the aim to interview athletes who are able to give information with regard to the needs of school-age high performance athletes throughout schools in Australia. Interviewing this group will provide reflective views on their experiences where useful information will be gathered about their lives while at school, Further, they may shed light on how schools could better serve the needs of school-age high performance athletes.

6.2.3. Group 2

6.2.3... Group name for participants in this group
Athletes still at school aged 15-18 years

6.2.3... Expected number of participants in this group

8

6.2.3... Age range

15-18 years

6.2.3... Other relevant characteristics of this participant group

These young people are school-age, high performance athletes. Nearly all young people who are at school are under the age of 18, hence a school-age athlete will be under the age of 18. A high performance athlete is identified as someone representing their country or their State in a sport at an adult level or at an age-group level, or is in a National Talent Squad in a sport.

6.2.3... Why are these characteristics relevant to the aims of the project?

School-age athletes will provide first-hand accounts of the needs and problems of school-age high performance athletes in trying to combine the demands of sport and education from their perspective. This information would be extremely valuable as this is the core interest of the research and this is where the most significant gap in the literature exists. In large part, the study stands or falls on the inclusion of this group.

6.2.3. Group 3

6.2.3... Group name for participants in this group

School officials

6.2.3... Expected number of participants in this group

14

6.2.3... Age range

22 - 70

6.2.3... Other relevant characteristics of this participant group

The participant will be a school official, such as a teacher, a coach or a school administrator, who has had experience in the schooling of school-age high performance athletes. This includes teachers, coaches and administrators at specialist sports schools and sports academies.

6.2.3... Why are these characteristics relevant to the aims of the project?

These people work in schools, and very closely with school-age high performance athletes. Therefore their views and perceptions of the schooling of these young people are vital to the data needed for the study. They will provide important evidence of the issues involved in the schooling of these young people from the perspective of the school.

6.2.3. Group 4

6.2.3... Group name for participants in this group

Parents

6.2.3... Expected number of participants in this group

14

6.2.3... Age range

30 - 60

6.2.3... Other relevant characteristics of this participant group

The participants will be parents or guardians of a school-age high performance athlete. Parents may be interviewed singly or in pairs as the situation arises.

6.2.3... Why are these characteristics relevant to the aims of the project?

Parents are a significant contributor to the success or otherwise of school-age high performance athletes and therefore they will provide valuable information about the problems of these young people in meeting athletic commitments and meeting school demands.

6.3. Participation experience

6.3.1 Provide a concise detailed description, in not more than 200 words, in terms which are easily understood by the lay reader of what the participation will involve.

Each participant will be asked to take part in an in-depth, semi-structured interview. The time, time required and the place of each interview will be flexible and will be determined at the participant's request. For adults, the interview is expected to last about 45 minutes to 1 hour. For those under the age of 18 the interview may well be shorter and the researcher will monitor this closely for levels of attention, loss of concentration, tiredness or other features that might spoil the quality of the interview or make the child feel uncomfortable. When there is an interview with both the parent and child present the researcher will firstly address both of them and suggest nicely that the interview is for the child and if the parent tries to take over the interview all be will paused and the taping stopped. At this time of pause in the interview the researcher will remind the parent once again this interview is for the child. If there is disagreement between the child and parent again the interview will be paused and the taping stopped and the researcher will remind the parent that the

interview is for the child to express their views. If the parent continues to interrupt the researcher will politely end the interview. Further, the researcher may note that this can be a stress placed upon some young athletes. The researcher will record the entire interview electronically, and the participant will have the transcript returned so that s/he may check what s/he has said and make any alterations or may withdraw from the research.
.

6.4. Relationship of researchers / investigators to participants

6.4.1 Specify the nature of any existing relationship or one likely to rise during the research, between the potential participants and any member of the research team or an organisation involved in the research.

There is no relationship between the target participants and the researcher, nor one likely to rise during the research. Each participant is either an athlete (over the age of 18 years old), athlete still at school aged 15-18 years old, parent or school official and the researcher is not employed by any of such groups, nor is she in any kind of contractual relationship with any of the groups targeted.
None of the principal researcher's six children are potential participants for this research.

6.4.2 Describe what steps, if any, will be taken to ensure that the relationship does not impair participants' free and voluntary consent and participation in the project.

As there is no relationship between the participants and the researcher it is highly unlikely to impair the participants' free and voluntary consent and participation in the project, or not to take part.

6.4.3 Describe what steps, if any, will be taken to ensure that decisions about participation in the research do not impair any existing or foreseeable future relationship between participants and researcher / investigator or organisations.

The participants are unlikely to have any further contact with the researcher after the interview, except in the cases when the transcript of the interview is returned to them, and they may wish to make comments or alterations to that, or indeed they may inform the researcher that they wish to withdraw from the whole project.

6.4.4 Will the research impact upon, or change, an existing relationship between participants and researcher / investigator or organisations.? No

6.4.5 Is it intended that the interview transcript will be shown or made available to participants? 3.1.15 Yes

6.4.5... Why is it considered important that participants have access to this information?

The interview transcript will be returned to participants following the transcription of the interview as it allows each participant to check through what they have said and to make changes that they wish. It also allows them another opportunity to review their participation and to withdraw if they are not comfortable with their experience or their contribution.

6.5. Recruitment

6.5.1 What processes will be used to identify potential participants?

All participants in the four groups will be from within Australia. From publicly available directories and word of mouth recommendations all groups will be identified. The initial groups for targeting are from the area in and around the Sunshine Coast, within a range of 200 kilometres from the University of the Sunshine Coast. Researchers expect a representative, purposive sample of each group would be approximately 8 - 14 participants so it is possible, but unlikely, that participants from beyond this range may be sought to achieve the sample size.

6.5.2 Is it proposed to 'screen' or assess the suitability of the potential participants for the study? No

6.5.3 Describe how initial contact will be made with potential participants.

Letters and information sheets will be sent to participants in the three groups of athletes (over 18 year old), athletes (15-18 year olds), parents and school officials to make initial contact. These three documents will introduce them to the research project and make a preliminary request for an interview for this research. The letters and information sheets are attached in the Appendix C.

6.5.3... Do you intend to include both males and females in this study? Yes

6.5.3... What is the expected ratio of males to females that will be recruited into this study and does this ratio accurately reflect the distribution of the disease, issue or condition within the general community?

The ratio is unknown, but gender is not expected to be a factor in determining trends among each group.

6.5.4 Is an advertisement, e-mail, website, letter or telephone call proposed as the form of initial contact with potential participants? Yes

6.5.4... Provide details and a copy of text/script.

The letter is intended as the initial contact and is provided in the Appendix.

6.5.5 If it became known that a person was recruited to, participated in, or was excluded from the research, would that knowledge expose the person to any disadvantage or risk? No

6.6. Consent process

6.6.1 Will consent for participation in this research be sought from all participants? Yes

6.6.1... Will there be participants who have capacity to give consent for themselves? Yes

6.6.1... What mechanisms/assessments/tools are to be used, if any, to determine each of these participant's capacity to decide whether or not to participate?

As indicated in the consent letter, the participants will be free to choose to participate or not based on information sent to them (see Appendix D). Three of the four groups are comprised of adults for whom there is no perceived problem in giving consent, which will be done by the signing of the consent form (attached in Appendix). For the group, Athletes still at school, the 15 year olds pawho will be participants, parents will be asked to sign the consent form with the child.

6.6.1... Are any of the participants children or young people? Yes

6.6.1... Explain how will the children or young people's vulnerability and capacity to consent be judged.

Consent will be sought from the parents of the participants who are in the Athletes who are still at school and are 15 years old. these children the researcher believes to be particularly immature and vulnerable and the consent of the parent or guardian will be sought. In each interview of athletes 15 years the researcher will firstly ask the child if they desire their parent or guardian to be present and if they so indicate the researcher will invite the parent /guardian to be present during the interview. In the case of 16 and 17 year old athletes still at school the child themselves will sign the consent form as the researcher deems these young people to be mature and not vulnerable. further, the researcher will firstly ask these young participants if they desire their parent or guardian to be present during the interview and if they indicate they would like this to occur the researcher will then invite the parent/guardian to be present during the interview.

6.6.1... Are there any children not of sufficient maturity to consent to participation? No

6.6.1... Will standing parental consent be relied upon for the participation of the children or young people? Yes

6.6.1... Will there be participants who do not have capacity to give consent for themselves? No

6.6.1... Describe the consent process, ie how participants or those deciding for them will be informed about, and choose whether or not to participate in, the project.

The four groups of participants, athlete , who have left school and over the age of 18 years,athlete still at school and aged between 15-18 years, parents and school officials will be contacted by letters (email) which will contain information on the proposal and its benefit for high performance school-age athletes. The purpose of the Research Information Sheet is to give them full details of the project to initially inform them of the information contained on the proposal and the potential benefits of the study. A follow up letter will then be forwarded to them, or a phone call made, to ask them if they are happy to proceed.. When the participants have read the information they will be contacted to see if there are any questions. Consent forms will usually be signed by both the researcher and the participant at the beginning of the interview. In the select group of athletes 15-18 year olds their parents will sign the consent forms at the interview time.

6.6.1... If a participant or person on behalf of a participant chooses not to participate, are there specific consequences of which they should be made aware, prior to making this decision? 4.6.6 - 4.6.7

No.

6.6.1... Might individual participants be identifiable by other members of their group, and if so could this identification expose them to risks?

No.

6.6.1... If a participant or person on behalf of a participant chooses to withdraw from the research, are there specific consequences of which they should be made aware, prior to giving consent?

No.

6.6.1... Specify the nature and value of any proposed incentive/payment (eg. movie tickets, food vouchers) or reimbursement (eg travel expenses) to participants.

There are no incentives.

6.6.1... Explain why this offer will not impair the voluntary nature of the consent, whether by participants' or persons deciding for their behalf. NS 2.2.10 - 2.2.11

There is no offer.

6.6.3 Do you propose to obtain consent from individual participants for your use of their stored data/samples for this research project? Yes

7. PARTICIPANTS SPECIFIC

7.2. Children or young people

7.2.1 Why is participation of children or young people indispensable to this research?

How has this study been designed to be appropriate for children or young people? NS 4.2.1

Interviewing school-age athlete will shed light on the perspective these young people hold about combining sport and education at the same time. Questions are simple, non-threatening and do not ask for any disclosure. All questions to be asked are indicated on the interview schedule contained in Appendix B . All the questions to this group of participants concern how they balance sport and schooling commitments. it is also expected that the interviews of these young people will be shorter than those of the adults.

7.2.2 Explain why there is no reason to believe that the research participation is not contrary to the best interests of the children or young people. NS 4.2.13 NS 4.3

There is no harm or hurt involved in interviewing these young people. Parents will be present or invited to attend the interview. There are important potential benefits in gaining the knowledge of these young people about how they combine sport and education, but this will be at no personal cost or hurt to these young people involved.

8. CONFIDENTIALITY/PRIVACY

8.1. Do privacy guidelines need to be applied in the ethical review of this proposal?

8.1.1 Indicate whether the source of the information about participants which will be used in this research project will involve:

[X] collection directly from the participant

8.1.1... Information which will be collected for this research project directly from the participant

8.1.1... Describe the information that will be collected directly from participants. Be specific where appropriate.

The interview schedules for each group of participants is provided in the appendices of this application. A common theme in all interviews will be the problems and conflicting demands of the school-age high performance athletes and how they cope with them. However, variations exist for each group. For athletes over the age of 18 years (athlete 1) this group will be asked to look back and provide views about their school experience and how it could have been made easier for them. For young people 15-18 years (athlete 2) questions will focus on their views of school, the competing demands of school and sport as they see it right now.

For parents the questions will focus around the relationship with the school and the advantages/disadvantages of the school their child is in. Also, questions will centre around the way parents work with schools to meet the needs and demands of their school-age high performance athlete. The final group is school officials such as school teachers where the questions will centre upon what do they see as problems in young people and how their school addresses such problems or issues for these young people.

8.1.1... The information collected by the research team about participants will be in the following form(s). Tick more than one box if applicable.

[X] re-identifiable

8.1.1... Give reasons why it is necessary to collect information in individually identifiable or re-identifiable form.

The researchers will de-identify participants in any reports, publications, or dissemination of results. However, information needs to be re-identified for two reasons. The first is to be able to return the transcript to participants for their perusal. More importantly, if a participant chooses to withdraw at a later date and wishes to withdraw all information that s/he has supplied, the information must be re-identifiable to allow this to happen. The information will be held in coded form, in a form selected by the participant,where the name and personal details of the participant will be kept securely from the research data. The information will only be identified by the researcher and that participant.

8.2. Using information from participants

8.2.1 Describe how information collected about participants will be used in this project.

Following the return of transcripts from the participants, information will be analysed using methods usually associated with qualitative data analysis, as suggested by Miles and Huberman (1994). N-Vivo will also be used to analyse and store the data. Coding will lead to the development of themes and categories which will be used to answer the research guiding questions.

Direct quotes will be used of the participants and the researcher will inform the participants of this before the interview commences. Further, this will be done with the permission from the participants and all care that participant's quotes utilised will not identify them.

The findings based on the information supplied by the participants will be published in a thesis, which will be submitted to examiners for the judgement of awarding a degree.

8.2.2 Will any of the information used by the research team be in identified or re-identifiable (coded) form? Yes

8.2.2... Indicate whichever of the following applies to this project:

[X] Information collected for, used in, or generated by, this project will/may be used for another purpose by the researcher for which ethical approval will be sought.

8.2.4 List ALL research personnel and others who, for the purposes of this research, will have authority to use or have access to the information and describe the nature of the use or access. Examples of others are: student supervisors, research monitors, pharmaceutical company monitors .

Dr. Bill Allen
Angela Calder
Maureen O'Neill

8.3. Storage of information about participants during and after completion of the project

8.3.1 In what formats will the information be stored during and after the research project? (eg. paper copy, computer file on floppy disk or CD, audio tape, videotape, film)

Interviews will be recorded onto a portable digital recording device " Livescribe pen". Immediately following the interview, the recording will be uploaded to the computer. Each interview will be marked with a code devised by the participant at the time of the interview and so known only to the researcher and the participant involved in that interview. A transcript will be made of the recorded interview and the notes from the 'Live Scribe pen" on Microsoft word. A hard copy and DVD/CD-rom will be sent to the participant for perusal and amendment if they so wish. Following any amendments to the transcript, the new hard copy, headed with the same code, will be the copy of the interview as the copy on the computer hard-drive will be erased.

8.3.2 Specify the measures to be taken to ensure the security of information from misuse, loss, or unauthorised access while stored during and after the research project? (eg. will identifiers be removed and at what stage? Will the information be physically stored in a locked cabinet?)

The names of the participants will be represented by a letter and code.
All information will be locked in a filing cabinet. The computer files will be stored on CD-roms/DVDs where only the management and research team will have access to them.

8.3.5 The information which will be stored at the completion of this project is of the following type(s). Tick more than one box if applicable.

[X] re-identifiable

8.3.5... Give reasons why it is necessary to store information in identifiable or potentially identifiable (coded) form.

The information has to be stored potentially identifiable form so that if a participant wishes to withdraw from the project the information supplied by that person is able to be sourced and destroyed or returned to the participant as they wish.
The information will be treated confidentially and no aspects which may identify the participant will be released in the research reports.
The information will be held in coded form, where the name and personal details of the participant will be kept securely separate from the research data. The data will only be identified by code.
This is to safeguard the athletes, parents and school officials form unauthorised persons reading the research.

8.3.5... If the data can be re-identified using a code, specify the security arrangements and access for the code.

The code will be determined by the participant at the time of the interview. all information will be stored on Cd-Roms/DVD in a locked filing cabinet in the home of the principal researcher. The principal researcher will only provide information to her supervisors as they request it for the purpose of assisting with data analysis and thesis writing. As such it will only be identifiable to the researcher and the individual participant.

8.3.6 For how long will the information be stored after the completion of the project and why has this period been chosen?

Information will be stored at the University for five years, to comply with the General Retention and Disposal Schedule for Queensland Universities (Queensland State Achievers). A copy of all information stored at the University of the Sunshine Coast for the duration of the project, including after the project has ended until it is disposed of. Information can be also be kept at the principal researcher's home and it be stored securely.

8.3.7 What arrangements are in place with regard to the storage of the information collected for, used in, or generated by this project in the event that the principal researcher / investigator ceases to be engaged at the current organisation?

The principal researcher will continue to have all information stored in a locked filing cabinet at her own home. Additionally, a copy of all information will be stored with her principal supervisor, Dr. Bill Allen, in a locked cabinet in his office at the University of the Sunshine Coast.

8.4. Ownership of the information collected during the research project and resulting from the research project

8.4.2 Who is understood to own the information resulting from the research, eg. the final report or published form of the results?

The researcher who is the PhD student at the university of the Sunshine Coast owns the information and there is no limitations on the publications the student would be making.

8.4.3 Does the owner of the information or any other party have any right to impose limitations or conditions on the publication of the results of this project? Yes

8.4.3... Specify any limitations on publication.

The information is owned by the student and it is intellectual property. It cannot be used in any other form other than that already specified unless further unless permission is given by the HREC at the University of the Sunshine Coast.

8.5. Disposal of the information

8.5.1 Will the information collected for, used in, or generated by this project be disposed of at some stage? Yes

8.5.1... At what stage will the information be disposed?
The information will be destroyed after five years in accordance with the General Retention and Disposal Schedule for Queensland Universities (Queensland State Archives)

8.5.1... How will information, in all forms, be disposed?
The electronic copies on DVD/CD-roms will be physically destroyed. The hard copies will be placed in a shredder owned by the University of the Sunshine Coast and will be removed by specialist security removalists.

8.6. Reporting individual results to participants and others

8.6.1 Is it intended that results of the research that relate to a specific participant be reported to that participant? No

8.6.1... Explain/justify why results will not be reported to participants.
There are no results as such from the research that could be directed at any one participant. In qualitative research like this, the return of the transcript for perusal and acceptance is about as far as one can go in reporting back to individual participants.

8.6.2 Is the research likely to produce information of personal significance to individual participants? No

8.6.3 Will individual participant's results be recorded with their personal records? No

8.6.4 Is it intended that results that relate to a specific participant be reported to anyone other than that participant? No

8.6.5 Is the research likely to reveal a significant risk to the health or well being of persons other than the participant, eg family members, colleagues No

8.6.6 Is there a risk that the dissemination of results could cause harm of any kind to individual participants - whether their physical, psychological, spiritual, emotional, social or financial well-being, or to their employability or professional relationships - or to their communities? No

8.6.7 How is it intended to disseminate the results of the research? eg report, publication, thesis
The main outcome of the research will be the required thesis for doctoral examination. Journal articles and conference papers are also expected to disseminate findings.
A summary of the research report will be made available to participants if they so wish.

8.6.8 Will the confidentiality of participants and their data be protected in the dissemination of research results? Yes

8.6.8... Explain how confidentiality of participants and their data will be protected in the dissemination of research results
All references to data obtained through interviews with the participants will be de-identified and thoroughly screened to ensure no unforeseen identification may occur. Any publication on the findings is only concerned with generalisations and there is no interest in specific, identifiable cases.

9. DECLARATIONS AND SIGNATURES

9.1 Project Title

High performance athletes at school: A study of conflicting demands

9.2 Human Research Ethics Committee to which this application is made

University of the Sunshine Coast Human Research Ethics Committee (EC00297)

9.3 Signatures and undertakings

Applicant / Principal Researchers (including students where permitted)

I/we certify that:
- All information is truthful and as complete as possible.
- I/we have had access to and read the National Statement on Ethical Conduct in Research Involving Humans.
- the research will be conducted in accordance with the National Statement.
- the research will be conducted in accordance with the ethical and research arrangements of the organisations involved.
- I/we have consulted any relevant legislation and regulations, and the research will be conducted in accordance with these.
- I/we will immediately report to the HREC anything which might warrant review of the ethical approval of the proposal NS 5.5.3 including:
  - serious or unexpected adverse effects on participants;
  - proposed changes in the protocol; and
  - unforseen events that might affect continued ethical acceptability of the project.
- I/we will inform the HREC, giving reasons, if the research project is discontinued before the expected date of completion NS 5.5.6 see NS 5.5.8(b);
- I/we will adhere to the conditions of approval stipulated by the HREC and will cooperate with HREC monitoring requirements. At a minimum annual progress reports and a final report will be provided to the HREC.

Applicant / Chief Researcher(s) / Principal Researcher(s)

Ms Maureen O'Neill _____ ____/____/_____
University of the Sunshine Coast Signature Date

Supervisor(s) of student(s)

I/we certify that:
- I/we will provide appropriate supervision to the student to ensure that the project is undertaken in accordance with the undertakings above;
- I/we will ensure that training is provided necessary to enable the project to be undertaken skilfully and ethically.

Dr Bill Allen _____ ____/____/_____
Signature Date

Ms Angela Calder _____ ____/____/_____
Signature Date

Heads of departments/schools/research organisation

I/we certify that:
- I/we are familiar with this project and endorse its undertaking;
- the resources required to undertake this project are available;
- the researchers have the skill and expertise to undertake this project appropriately or will undergo appropriate training as specified in this application.

_____ _____ _____
Title First name Surname

_____ _____
Position Organisation name

____/____/____ _____
Date Signature

10. ATTACHMENTS

This page and all pages that follow don't need to be submitted to your HREC.

10.1 List of Attachments

Core Attachments	Attachments which may be required/appropriate.
Recruitment/invitation	Copy of advertisement, letter of invitation etc
Participant Information	Copy or script for participant Copy or script for parent, legal guardian or person responsible as appropriate
Consent Form	Copy for participant For parent, legal guardian or person responsible as appropriate For, optional components of the project eg. genetic sub study
Peer review	Copy of peer review report or grant submission outcome
HREC approvals	Copy of outcome of other HREC reviews

Attachments specific to project or participant group	Attachments which may be required/appropriate.
Research conducted in the workplace or possibly impacting on workplace relationships	Evidence of support/permission from workplace where research will be conducted
Children and/or young people (ie. <18 years)	Information/consent form for parent, legal guardian or person responsible
Aboriginal and/or Torres Strait Islander peoples	Evidence of support / permission of elders and/or other appropriate bodies

10.2 Participant information elements
Core Elements
Provision of information to participants about the following topics should be considered for all research projects.

Core Elements	Issues to consider in participant information
About the project	Full title and / or short title of the project Plain language description of the project Purpose / aim of the project and research methods as appropriate Demands, risks, inconveniences, discomforts of participation in the project Outcomes and benefits of the project Project start, finish, duration
About the investigators / organisation	Researchers conducting the project (including whether student researchers are involved) Organisations which are involved / responsible Organistions which have given approvals Relationship between researchers and particpants and organisations
Participant description	How and why participants are chosen How participants are recruited How many participants are to be recruited
Participant experience	What will happen to the particant, what will they have to do, what will they experience? Benefits to individual, community, and contribution to knowledge Risks to individual, community Consequences of participation
Participant options	Alternatives to participation Whether participation may be for part of project or only for whole of project Whether any of the following will be provided: counselling, post research follow-up, or post research access to services, equipment or goods
Participants rights and responsibilities	That participation is voluntary That participants can withdraw, how to withdraw and what consequences may follow Expectations on participants, consequences of non-compliance with the protocol How to seek more information How to raise a concern or make a complaint
Handling of information	How information will be accessed, collected, used, stored, and to whom data will be disclosed Can participants withdraw their information, how, when Confidentiality of information Ownership of information Subsequent use of information Storage and disposal of information
Unlawful conduct	Whether researcher has any obligations to report unlawful conduct of participant
Financial issues	How the project is funded Declaration of any duality of interests Conspensation entitlements Costs to participants Payments, reimbursements to participants Commercial application of results
Results	What will particpants be told, when and by whom Will individual results be provided What are the consequences of being told or not being told the results of

Core Elements	Issues to consider in participant information
	research How will results be reported / published Ownership of intellectual property and commercial benefits
Cessation	Circumstances under which the participation of an individual might cease Circumstances under which the project might be terminated

Research Specific Elements
Provision of information to participants about the following topics should be considered as may be relevant to the research project.

Specific to project or participant group	Additional issues to consider in participant information
Aboriginal and/or Torres Strait Islander peoples	describe consultation process to date and involvement of leaderswhether ATSI status will be recorded